Trail

Contents

[English text unavailable] 2
[English text unavailable] 3
[English text unavailable] 6
[English text unavailable] 8
[English text unavailable] 10

[English text unavailable]

COL-8002601

Female Voice: Oh? Looks like we've got a new arrival.

Male Voice: It's pitch black in here. Can't be sure she's new just yet.

Female Voice: Hey there! Welcome to La Sociedad de Poetas de las Américas!

Male Voice: Or maybe she's one of those who broke out and came back of her own accord?

Male Voice: Keeping quiet, huh? I get it. This must be a sacred moment for you. A "return to the darkness."

Corridor, Comala Prison

Dores: La Sociedad de Poetas ... de las Américas?

The textures she felt on her way here do not match the words she just heard. Guided by her keen hearing, she pauses mid-step in what seems to be a reasonably open space.

The room falls into silence—like the longest minute in human history.

Dores: Are you still there?

A faint cough, a heave of a sigh in the darkness.

Dores: Pardon me, but have we met before? This is my first time in this prison, as far as I can recall.

Female Voice: What a strange thing to say—"prison"! When was the last time we heard someone say that? Back when The Narrator was published?

Female Voice: Wait. You aren't some ancient ghost here in pursuit of realism, are you?

There is a theatrical flair in her voice.

Male Voice: Rusty gates, pitch-black cells—"prison."

Male Voice: Bars for exchanging letters, a peaceful and secluded place—"Sociedad de Poetas."

Male Voice: And no, we don't know you.

The three of them are spaced just far enough apart to barely make out each other's faces in the dark.

Female Voice: What a wonderful example, García. Exactly! It all depends on how you choose to see the world, my new friend.

García: Roberta, we don't have much time. This might be the most important gathering of the month—no, maybe even of the year.

Roberta: You're right, García. At this moment, nothing is more important than the salon the Idealist has so carefully prepared.

García: You should focus on sorting out those manuscripts first.

Dores: Pardon the interruption, but might I ask why your organization is called "La Sociedad de Poetas de las Américas"? I assume it isn't simply due to geography.

Roberta: Don't worry, Señora. We make it a point to introduce our Sociedad to every new friend, but now isn't quite the time. After the salon ends, we'll ask the jailer about your accommodations.

García: Wait a minute. Roberta, your eyes are well-adjusted to the dark. Use them.

García: She's neither a newcomer nor a returnee. She ... she's a blind woman.

Roberta: Ah, please forgive García's rudeness, Señora! A sensory limitation can sometimes bring sharper intuition. In that colorful world of the mind, I'm sure what you see is even more beautiful than reality.

Roberta: But ... if you weren't brought in by the Physician, then why are you here?

Dores: ...

She tries to construct a fiction in her mind, something that could justify the surreal nature of her arrival.

Comala Prison Perimeter

Dores: From the humid trade winds of São Paulo to the crashing surf on the cliffs. Now, this strange land greets me for the first time with nothing but cold silence.

Ms. Grace: "Ms. Urd is to be placed in Ushuaia's Comala Prison. She is not to be treated as an ordinary inmate."

Ms. Grace: In the words of the Preacher, you are our honored guest, Ms. Urd.

Dores: I've come to learn the name of this land, Ushuaia, from that young lady's retelling. It lies at the southernmost tip of the vast continent of South America.

Dores: As we walked, I could feel her gaze upon me. Steady, yet never intrusive. I could tell she meant me no harm.

Ms. Grace: I've informed the administrator of Comala Prison of your identity and special circumstances. He will ensure your safety.

Ms. Grace: Good luck, and farewell.

Dores: I sensed I had been brought to a place most unusual—a building with a quiet peculiarity in the air. Two attendants followed close behind me, some form of liquid dripping from their faces.

Dores: I suppose I must claim a little freedom for myself in this place. I thought the darkness was a blessing. It wasn't too difficult to shake them off.

Dores: I'm sorry for your undue trouble, my diligent friends.

Dores: I'm a writer, and I mostly write under the name "Urd." I'm here for a short visit, hoping to find some inspiration for my next story. I'm afraid I don't know of this Physician you mentioned.

Roberta: See, García? This lady is a writer! A good soul! You almost made us miss out on meeting a kindred spirit.

Roberta: Come, come! I'm sure you'll fall in love with our salon!

García: This ... this has nothing to do with me. It's dark in here, but I suppose you've already grown used to walking in the dark. Sorry, I mean no offense.

[English text unavailable]

COL-8002602

Hall of New Encounters

Inmate I: I read in an article once that you Chileans don't like Baroque literature—something about it being too noisy. You sure are a quiet bunch.

Inmate II: Is that so? And you Argentinians just love it, right? If you're any metric to go by, I'd say you're all loud and obnoxious.

Inmate I: You—just because the Idealist isn't here, you think you can turn this salon into a debate hall?!

Inmate II: You started it ...

Julio: Enough! Stop squabbling and post your work so we can read it.

Julio: If you ask me, you're simply more interested in rhythm than form. Spanish is a rich language, one that is inherently expressive, ever-changing, and artistic—much like Baroque literature.

The typically quiet man's words douse the argument like a cold splash of water, sending the group into a rare moment of calm.

Roberta: Haha! All jokes aside, I do miss them. Ever since those mad members left La Sociedad, we've had far fewer breakthroughs in stream-of-consciousness writing.

Roberta: I, for one, would gladly discuss the "aesthetic value" of stream-of-consciousness composition.

As this new topic surfaces, the inmates' voices begin to rise once again.

Dores: It was a most unusual literary salon, full of emotionally charged statements and biased opinions.

Dores: But I didn't mind it. In fact, my feeling was quite the opposite. The inmates give me an incredible feeling. Not one of them saw themselves as a prisoner stripped of their freedom.

Dores: A group of literature enthusiasts coming together in an abandoned prison and collaborating to build an ideal nation ...

Dores: It felt as though it was the result of some kind of pact. But in reality, it was clearly a government-run prison.

???: Everyone, quiet down! I have something to announce.

An unfamiliar voice cuts off the clacking typewriter in Dores's mind.

A woman walks out from the far end of the darkness and steps into the center of the salon, stopping before the whiteboard and podium.

Octavia: Mr. Idealist entrusted me with hosting the literature salon. He left a letter under a stone in the corner stating that he had a personal matter to attend to.

Octavia: For this session, I will now announce our next research topic—

Octavia: "Fiction's Duality in Reflecting Reality and the Self."

Heavy gasps, turned heads—an uproar spreads through the audience. Clearly, this wasn't the topic they were expecting.

She raises the letter in her hand in a gesture for silence.

Octavia: Like-minded fellows, aspiring writers ... Since the turn of the century, the names that once shook the literary world have gradually faded into obscurity.

Octavia: Literature's been shoved aside in the world of art. People attend theaters, cinemas, and even art galleries to enjoy paintings and sculptures, but few can finish a book.

Octavia: What is left for us to do? When families are torn apart and our nations are ravaged by tyranny?

Octavia: Let stories be our weapon! They should be the sword that cuts through the bloody truth! The beacon that lights our way forward!

The audience falls into silence.

García: You could try writing a Latin American War and Peace. And we could continue with our original salon topic. The two aren't mutually exclusive.

García: I've spent the whole month preparing for the topic the Idealist previously proposed.

García: If you insist on changing the subject, then I'm afraid I'll have to take my leave.

Roberta: Ms. Octavia, forgive me for interrupting, but this isn't the topic we agreed on.

Roberta: Everything you've said ... we just can't do that! We haven't even figured out things for ourselves yet.

Julio: Octavia, it's an interesting topic, it is. But perhaps we can talk about it another time.

Julio: Besides, don't forget the reason you're in here in the first place—for preaching that "the novel is a weapon."

Inmate I: Yeah, if it weren't for your rich daddy, you'd be on the gallows, not standing here preaching to us.

Another prisoner stands, his voice clear.

Inmate III: You've completely missed Ms. Octavia's point! A great writer should be like an obsessive gravedigger, digging up the rotting flesh of social realism from the grave of our times!

Inmate III: Only this vast crucible is worthy to be the host of our literature!

Dores: At that time, Mr. García looked visibly resistant as Mr. Julio issued stern reminders and Ms. Roberta attempted to mediate.

Dores: More and more members joined the debate, and voices both for and against Ms. Octavia's proposal emerged. It didn't take long for La Sociedad to split into two camps.

Dores: That was when I realized I needed to do something—to get this derailed literary salon back on the tracks.

Dores: Please allow me to introduce myself. I'm Dores, from São Paulo. I'm a writer, and I mostly write under the name "Urd."

Octavia: Urd? That name sounds familiar.

Octavia: Have you written for UTTU? Are you the Urd in UTTU? Wow, I never imagined we'd be welcoming such an honored guest today! I thoroughly enjoyed your piece titled The Tin Soldiers of São Paulo.

Dores: It's an important part of my visit to hear all the ideas and opinions, if you'll pardon my intrusion.

Octavia: Then, tell me, Ms. Urd, what are your thoughts on today's salon topic?

A difficult question, one involving preference, a creative stance, and a political alignment.

A scale that is never easily balanced. However, the answer has never been the most important part of such questions.

Dores: In these restless times, literature has been overlooked, forgotten, pushed to the edges of the world ...

Dores: Much like Ushuaia.

Some fall into deep thought, others nod in agreement, and a few look puzzled. The audience is largely unaware that the topic has already shifted.

Dores: To most, this prison at the end of the world is a distant, cold place. Perhaps even a place of hopelessness.

Dores: When a prisoner is first sent here, I cannot help but imagine that the first thing they feel is a stagnant pool of water and a calm, quiet despair.

She seizes this chance to guide the literary salon back from the muddy trenches of ideology.

She recalls the days of typing while looking out over the river, boats, and palm trees. Words are honest. They have no capacity to lie.

Dores: I came here to gather material for my next book. I plan to record everything I experience in this place—faithfully.

Octavia: And what kind of work are you planning to write? A nonfiction piece, I presume? About Comala Prison?

Dores: Its theme is "Fate."

[English text unavailable]

COL-8002603

Octavia: Fate ... yes. It looms over us, yet each of us may hold the power to steer its course.

Octavia: Just like this nation of contradictions. Its fate should also be ...

Roberta: Ahem! In that case, shall we officially begin this salon?

The ever-observant Roberta, noticing the tears welling in Octavia's eyes, cuts her off.

Roberta: Would anyone like to share a story on this topic?

Roberta: Whether it's a personal experience or a written tale, let's bring some life to this salon!

Roberta: Well, if no one has anything to say, I could always retell the story of my fateful journey across the Mexican border ...

screech

A chair screeches as one man stands. All eyes fall on his face, shadowed by his heavy brow and sharp cheekbones.

An unexpected twist. No one noticed him quietly sitting at the edge of the crowd until now.

Julio: I spent the first half of my life as a bank clerk. One day, sitting behind that glass window, staring at the endless stacks of checks, papers, and flyers, it hit me. I was serving a life sentence.

Julio: So I quit, went home, and decided to write something. My wife threw a fit at first, but when I wouldn't budge, a cold war broke out between us, and then finally, she issued a unilateral eviction notice.

Julio: I got drunk, punched a bastard officer who was beating a beggar in the street, and everything after that's a blur. When I came to, I was already here—a place that feels more like home than any other place ever did.

Julio: The Idealist gave me some water and suggested I write to Aleph.

Julio: So I did. I wrote a letter and asked a question.

Julio: Two weeks later, I got a reply. Just one line. I'm still trying to figure out what it means.

Julio: "In the short span of life, there exists an infinitely extending staircase, and at its end lies nothing but a silent body of water."

Roberta: Julio, I had no idea you had such a story. Why haven't you mentioned it before?

Octavia: I didn't know you've written to Aleph too.

Julio: Octavia, maybe you did choose the right topic. Young, passionate writers like you should carry the dream of changing society.

Julio: Don't end up like me—waiting until this age to finally pick up the pen.

Octavia: Oh?

The hostess, fully engrossed in the story, has almost forgotten all about the topic.

Roberta: Great. I suppose it's my turn, then. So, here's my tale of crossing the Mexican border—

Inmate III: For heaven's sake, spare us! I've heard at least seven or eight versions of that story already. Not to mention the five short stories in your collection.

Inmate III: Five stories, Roberta, five! And the only difference between them is the narrative perspective!

García: Repetitive narrative is indeed an important topic in literary criticism ...

The remainder of the salon is spent in noisy chatter as the storytelling quickly spirals out of control.

Only Doctor Dores quietly repeats that name to herself.

Dores: "Aleph"?

Dores: Mr. Julio's past was an unexpected gold nugget—the perfect material for a biography. I'll treat it with care in my next submission.

Dores: By then, I had nearly forgotten I was still in prison. I had been swept up in the literary salon.

Dores: I resolved to record all that I witnessed in this prison. As to whether the inhabitants are truly prisoners—that will be for the readers to decide.

Dores: At the time, I did not ask how they found their way into this prison. Like them, I was thinking of purer things.

Dores: Looking back on this journey, I now see that the tangled strands of las babas del diablo had formed an interconnected web.

Just as the salon gets into full swing, a face emerges from the shadows, only the smile clearly visible.

The Idealist: Rarely do I observe the salon from afar, taking in all its symbolic quirks and subtle metaphors.

The Idealist: The bridge between reality and unreality, the poetry of the typical and the atypical! This is exactly how I envisioned La Sociedad de Poetas de las Américas when I founded it.

The new arrival catches her attention.

Dores: Reality and unreality ... Are you referring to the difference between nonfiction and fiction? I'm afraid I haven't quite grasped your full meaning.

The Idealist: Ah, but you understood at least part of it, didn't you? That alone proves we're walking the same path—the unwavering pursuit of aesthetic truth!

The Idealist: We are citizens of the literary kingdom, stargazers chasing the first light to reach the shores of the New World, children crying beneath the tree of pure ideals.

The Idealist: As its founder, I sincerely invite you to join La Sociedad de Poetas de las Américas and become one of us.

Dores: Join ... La Sociedad de Poetas de las Américas?

A gentlemanly bow. An invitation that is hard to refuse.

Everything here carries an air of mystery—the literary gathering, the strange architecture, the enigmatic recipient of all those letters.

A rare opportunity.

Dores: I'm truly flattered by your invitation. I'd be delighted to join the poetry society.

Dores: But might I trouble you with one question, Mr. Idealist? You call yourself the founder, so I assume you are THE "Idealist," yes?

The Idealist: Ask away.

Dores: Could you tell me about "Aleph"?

[English text unavailable]

COL-8002604

Dores: Up to this point, I have participated firsthand in several sessions of La Sociedad de Poetas de las Américas.

Dores: Those literary experiments treated language as an advanced game, weaving reality and fiction into an invisible web, ensnaring everyone present in a maze of words.

Dores: Never before had I been so intimate with literature or thought about it so deeply. I was amazed by how words could so vividly express both playfulness and values.

Dores: Until that ordinary afternoon, when a poet named Edoardo was reciting his new piece with refined rhythm, and Ms. Octavia was discussing the state of São Paulo with me.

Dores: No one noticed anything unusual about Mr. Julio's condition.

Octavia: Just like you wrote in The Tin Soldiers of São Paulo:

Octavia: "The greatness of Latin America lies in its richness, and from that richness comes misfortune, gnawed by insatiable greed. One man's poverty is another's feast. Suffering nourishes joy. They are like riverbanks, clearly divided."

Octavia: This duality, this paradox—isn't it precisely the kind of question we should be posing through literature?

The thud of bone against a hard surface interrupts her. Julio is banging his head against the wall.

Julio: Not enough, not enough! Not like this—you can't grasp—space and time!

Julio: I'm still missing—some essential—language frameworks—and thought patterns ...!!

Julio: With our current—language system—I cannot catch—the ghost of time. I can only—let it—slip away—from the tip of my pen ...

Octavia: Mr. Julio, what's wrong with you?!

Unlike the panicked Octavia, the other inmates around Julio seem unfazed.

Inmate IV: That wall is unscalable, Julio. I told you already. I can lend you some of my bandages from last week if you need them.

Inmate IV: For a permanently silent object, any form of narration is futile. In the end, you're just wrestling with your own shadow.

Octavia: What are you all standing around for? Can't you see Julio's hurting himself?

Octavia is clearly flustered. Dores knows she must first eliminate any outside interference that might obstruct her ability to help.

Dores: Ms. Octavia, please calm down. Tell me—what do you see?

Octavia: It's Mr. Julio! He's hurt! Bleeding!

Octavia: He tried to break through the mirror of language with his head. But it was actually a wall!

By now, Dores has learned how to filter out the surreal embellishments typical of La Sociedad members in order to correctly assess the situation.

Mirror or wall? It doesn't matter.

Dores: Please take a closer look and describe what you see—clearly and without embellishment. What is Mr. Julio's condition?

Octavia: His muscles are spasming uncontrollably, as if jolted by a cold electric current; his face is tightening, twisting, like he's struggling against a silent force. His fingers are curling into unnatural shapes ...

Octavia: His expression keeps changing. First pain, then panic, and finally ... blankness.

Dores: Sounds like he's having an epileptic seizure. Perhaps I could offer some help.

Guided by the sound of Julio's whimpers, Dores approaches. His head is bloodied.

Dores: Please, Ms. Octavia. Help me, so I can help him. Could you lay him down flat on his side? We have to stop him from hurting himself.

Octavia: I—I can use my arcane skill!

Dores: Flashing lights could worsen an epileptic seizure. Does your arcane skill emit intense light? If so, I must ask you to refrain from using it.

Octavia hurriedly retracts her incantation. She presses down on Julio's shoulder and lowers him onto the cold, hard floor.

The doctor kneels quickly and gently turns the man onto his side, preventing him from injuring himself any further.

Dores: As time passed, Mr. Julio's convulsions began to subside, but his body remained stiff, his jaw clenched tight. I took a disposable bite pad from the first-aid kit and carefully placed it in his mouth to keep him from biting himself.

Dores: Eventually, the situation came under control, and Mr. Julio's breathing stabilized.

Dores: And there everyone went, straight back to the gathering as if it were only a minor inconvenience.

Octavia: Thank you for your help, Ms. Urd.

The doctor responds with a silent smile.

Octavia: You seem experienced. Was it a major part of your responsibilities in São Paulo?

Dores: Yes. Saving others is my profession; writing is my hobby. In my home, I am first and foremost a doctor.

Octavia: Ms. Urd, you have my utmost admiration. As a doctor, as a writer, and even more as a person beyond any social categorization.

Octavia: You, a doctor who actually lived in the favelas, pointed the barrel at yourself before wielding your words as a weapon.

Octavia: Compared to you, I've achieved nothing of substance. All I do is wave ideals around. As if that's enough ...

Dores: Ms. Octavia, I am simply a writer who follows her curiosity. I'm afraid I'm not qualified to provide you with any concrete advice, nor am I as great as you say.

Dores: You're well-prepared for your vision and ambition, for modesty is such an essential part of writing, and you've just demonstrated a skillful use of introspection.

Octavia: Thank you for your kind words. But I'd like to return to my room and think for a while. See you tomorrow.

Cell, Comala Prison

Octavia: The Idealist pursues his ideal to erect a magnificent vision atop the tower of literature.

Octavia: But for those outside the tower, what good is that magnificence?

Octavia: Here I am, locked away in a prison, my words going no further than these walls. I even only have my life because of my wretched father.

Octavia: It was foolish to think that ideas alone could ease people's pain. Maybe we're no different from the heretics who were burned at the stake in the Middle Ages.

Octavia: Perhaps only professionals like Ms. Urd—doctors with real expertise—can truly save a person.

Octavia: Wait ... but this prison does have a doctor. A doctor meant to handle every kind of issue, whose specialty is precisely in the mental field.

Octavia: But he's not just a doctor. He's the overseer of this prison!

Octavia: I once asked the Idealist why the person in charge here wasn't a regular jailer or a police chief, but a Physician. As expected, he brushed me off with some grandiose, idealistic rhetoric.

Octavia: But why has the Idealist always seemed so opposed to the Physician?

Octavia: Why can't patients like Mr. Julio, who are clearly suffering, be sent to him?

Octavia: Puzzles on top of puzzles. Questions after questions. My head ...

Her sigh echoes through the circular building, and it is soon answered by a chorus of other sighs.

Octavia: I can't do this anymore.

Dores: Ms. Octavia turned and walked away. Though she looked disheartened, I could still see the power of the unwavering force that drove her forward.

Dores: What would that force be for me?

Dores: Looking back, I too began to reflect on myself—to contemplate "fate," that grand and irreversible force.

[English text unavailable]

COL-8002605

Dores: After that, I attended several more literary salons and wrote things I had never dared write before. Ms. Octavia, however, never made an appearance.

Dores: I didn't see her for quite some time. That was until I followed some prisoners to a large hall and heard her voice among a group of unfamiliar inmates.

Dores: She noticed me and greeted me warmly. She told me she had been working on some new initiatives.

Dores: She told me of her hopes to gather more support—to improve conditions in the prison and initiate a spiritual shift toward realism and resistance.

Dores: I truly believed, back then, that everything was heading in the right direction.

Before all eyes, the host of the assembly, the Idealist, steps up to the podium.

The Idealist: By the randomness of fate, we have gathered here to participate in the Comala Congress.

The Idealist: Before the eyes of destiny, historians, and astrologers alike, I now declare a new rule amendment:

The Idealist: "A duel before a crowd of eager eyes. The winner awarded ten pounds of gold, and the loser left with ten flies to descend upon him."

The Idealist: Before the Comala Congress convenes, we shall assign two members of La Sociedad this noble mission—a duel decreed by fate.

Dores hears the faint clink of a small object rattling inside a box.

The Idealist: José, Julio, step forward and draw the sharpest blade of your literary thought!

The Idealist: According to the rules, I will preside over this duel with fairness and impartiality. Now, prepare yourselves!

The absurd, fictional, metaphysical duel ends within a fraction of a second. The victorious prisoner receives ten shining golden pills, while the loser collapses to the floor.

The crowd erupts into chaos, Octavia's cries rising above the noise.

Dores: What's going on?

Octavia: Mr. Julio ... He—he's having another seizure!

Octavia: Ms. Urd, please, Julio needs your help!

The Idealist: Octavia, you know this is all part of the randomness of fate.

Octavia: The randomness ... of fate?

She doesn't argue back as she usually would. Instead, she stands frozen in place, as if stunned.

Dores: What's the matter, Ms. Octavia? This is an emergency. I require your assistance.

The Idealist: Answer me, Octavia. Why are you trying to change Julio's fate?

Octavia: Because ... no one should die like this ...

Octavia: I don't want him to die.

Dores: Please, Ms. Octavia, help me, so I can help him.

Octavia: I—I ...

Her voice cracks, leaving only the sound of her stifled sobs lingering in the air.

Dores: What's wrong, Ms. Octavia? How's his condition now?

Dores: Ms. Octavia?

Octavia: ...

She remains silent. After a long pause, she casts the heavy stone into the bottomless water.

Octavia: Ms. Urd.

Octavia: Mr. Julio is gone. He left us the moment the duel was over.

How could that be?

Seizures can potentially lead to irreversible brain damage, but how could it happen so fast?

A precious life, gone so quickly, swept away by something so senseless, lost in a nonsensical duel.

Dores: What exactly is this so-called "Congress"? Some kind of punitive system unique to Comala Prison? But how can someone's life be decided by something so absurd?

Dores: Are we simply meant to surrender to a fate so twisted, no matter how absurd it is? Is it so irrefutable? This isn't the "fate" I seek. It's a distortion of it.

Octavia: It's my fault, for not finding a better way.

Octavia: I used to think Mr. Julio didn't care about anything but his own novels. I never imagined my ideals would mean anything to him.

Octavia: But he was the first person in La Sociedad to support me.

Octavia: But that really was an irreversible fate, a fate granted to Mr. Julio by the Die of Babylon.

Dores: The Die ... of Babylon?

Her question is left unanswered. The host of the salon goes on.

The Idealist: Julio has stepped off the endless staircase and reached the silent water.

The Idealist: He has become as calm water, dissolved into his own pond. Let us offer our blessings, our silence, our farewell to this martyr of fate.

The Idealist: And let us imagine that Julio's literary career was a happy one.

The hall remains deathly silent. No applause. No response.

Octavia: A life was taken, and that's all you have to say? You really don't care whether we live or die, do you, Idealist?

Octavia: And all of you?! Don't any of you have anything to say? Why are you all just standing there?

Octavia: If we hadn't kept rejecting the Physician's treatment, maybe Mr. Julio wouldn't have ...

The Idealist: Rejecting? How ridiculous! You have no clue what that demon in human skin is capable of—how he'll reach into your mind and mold it like clay, reshaping it until it becomes your prison.

The Idealist: In the realm of fiction, fate, unreality—the dissolution of the ego is inevitable and irreversible. Therefore, we must not resist the ending dealt to us by the Die of Babylon!

Octavia: Do you even know what you're talking about? I've never truly understood you, Idealist.

Octavia: I will find a better way. I must rewrite this tragic tale!

The Idealist: If you disagree, then leave La Sociedad. I will not have our great poem disrupted by an offbeat syllable.

The Idealist: Besides, your tedious talk of social responsibility should've been purged long ago. Modern Latin America belongs to visceral realism, and you're too ignorant to even attempt to seek it out!

Octavia: Ha, haha! What a ridiculous, laughable man you are!

Octavia: Yes, I see it clearly now.

Octavia: It's your tyranny that has driven everyone to ruin!

Octavia: Well, let me tell you something. I'm not leaving. I will establish a new literary movement right here in Comala, right here in La Sociedad de Poetas de las Américas.

Octavia: And I—no, we—will use our literature to rescue the inmates who suffer all around us.

Octavia: I've had enough of your condescending, stone-hearted ego and your pompous sophistry!

Octavia: You only bring misfortune upon us with this constant rambling about that visceral realism! I hope I never see you again. Ms. Urd, we have to get you out of here. Another second around, this maniac might just doom us all!

Octavia: Only the Physician—the true overseer of this prison—can save us from this situation!

Octavia: Please join the society, Ms. Dores! Help us build a renewed Sociedad de Poetas together!

Octavia: I've already spoken with the jailer. As long as we follow the rules and help them manage Comala, we'll be free to discuss literature.

Dores: Forgive me, Ms. Octavia. While I truly appreciate your kind offer, I'm afraid my conversation with the Physician must remain private.

Octavia: Why?

Dores: Please answer me this question first. From what you've seen, you'd say this prison is circular in shape, yes?

Octavia: Yes, it is.

Dores: Then tell me—at the center of this structure, is there a watchtower?

Octavia: What ... impossible! You guessed it exactly. And our destination is somewhere inside that watchtower. How did you know?

Dores: I've had such a lovely time here, so much so that I almost forgot what I came for.

Dores: Which is precisely why I must put an end to this cruel farce masquerading as fate.

Octavia: Do you intend to rebel against the watchtower's gaze, just like the Idealist?

Dores: You misunderstand me, Ms. Octavia.

Dores: That inescapable gaze and the permanent theme of "fate" ... To get closer to the truth I seek, I have no choice but to meet the administrator that young lady spoke of.

Dores: You've decided to save the people here with your own hands, in your own way, and so have I. There are things I must face alone.

Though she is well used to death, the pain of Julio's passing still lingers in her heart, causing her to say these words that don't quite feel like herself.

Octavia: I see. Lend me your palm; I'll draw you the way to his office.

Octavia: Good luck to you, and to all of us.

Dores: Farewell, Ms. Octavia. I truly hope all goes well for you in the days ahead ...

As Octavia retreats, slowly fading into the distance, she quietly adds—

Dores: ... and in your journey finding answers about "fate," too.